



Predator is coming to Wildlands

The Predator is coming to Ghost Recon: Wildlands in a free special event running until early January. <http://dgit.in/PredWild>



AC: Origins review bombed

Assassin's creed origins was recently review bombed on metacritic... with positive reviews. <http://dgit.in/ACOREvBom>

Well, I didn't sign up for this

One of our readers is fed up with all the spyware that device manufacturers have on their products and boy is he angry!

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I lost my phone some time ago and ended up switching back to a spare, almost 5 year old iPhone 5S. As soon as I switched on the phone and set it up, I checked the update section. iOS11 had just come out and my phone was eligible for the update. I was just about to tap the update icon, when I stopped. I had recently read a theory that Apple deliberately slows down its older phone models through updates, so that the customer gets frustrated, and are forced to upgrade. I was never an Apple fanboy, infact I spent my early teenage days belittling Apple and telling everybody, whether they were listening or not, how amazing Android is. As I grew up, I accepted the fact that I was wrong. Apple makes amazing products. I never made the switch because I liked Android way too much, and Apple was expensive. I knew I had to use this phone for some time before I could buy a new one, and I didn't want it to slow down. The phone worked completely fine, except for its battery life and the camera, which was expected. I went on with my day to day life. Then Apple made a statement, accepting THAT THEY DELIBERATELY SLOW DOWN THEIR OLDER PHONE MODELS WITH EVERY UPDATE.

The alleged conspiracy wasn't just a theory anymore. With age and maturity, I had gotten rid of my juvenile beliefs, and started to actually like Apple. For their designs, finish, ease of use and even the marketing. They lost all that in a day.

Apple said they had been doing this for only a year and they didn't want the older phones to shut down unexpectedly, but I am not going to believe them. (I just finished watching the 3rd season of *Mr. Robot*)

This is not a standalone case, and surely not the worst. The optimist in me told me that atleast they didn't de-



liberately install spyware on my phone. Lets look at few of the headlines of the past year:

- **Lenovo Caught (3rd Time) Pre-Installing Spyware on its Laptops**
- **26 Android Phone Models from Xiaomi, Huawei and Lenovo Shipped with Pre-Installed Spyware**
- **Xiaomi Mi 4 Smartphone Pre-loaded with Malware and Custom Android ROM**
- **HardCoded Backdoor Found in China-made Netis, Netcore Routers**
- **Lenovo Caught Using Rootkit to Secretly Install Unremovable Software**

These are news headlines from thehackernews.com, one of the biggest cybersecurity news web sites out there.

The next phone I am (was?) planning to buy was the Moto Z2 Play. And Lenovo own motorola right?

George Orwell was right. The conspiracy theorists were right. 'Big Brother is watching you' isn't just paranoia talk now. Over time I have accepted that governments and other entities have the capability to know my each and every move. I just told myself that I am not an important enough a target and pushed this thought to the back of my head. After all, ignorance is bliss.

The latest acceptance by Apple has brought back all my fears. Apple is probably the least 'worst' of the lot.

They weren't spying, but they put something in my phone without telling me about it.

I want to ask all these companies, who gave them the right to install these software on my devices? Did they mention it in their finely printed term of conditions? Or the salesman at my local store forgot to tell me about this 'feature'? When did I sign up for this?

I feel cheated. I paid my hard earned money for their product/service and they slipped in a micro-phone with it to spy on me. I don't care anymore if I am not 'special' enough to be targeted. What if hackers used these backdoors and spyware for malicious intent? Why did you put it in if you didn't have malicious intent?

I just called up my highschool friend at 2 am in the night to apologise for making fun of him when he covered his laptop's webcam with tape.

I don't know who to go to, who to complain. I didn't sign up for it, and I am sure you didn't. This has been happening for quite some time. I can see the problem. I don't see the solution. Is there anybody I can trust? Let me know if anything can help me. 